

Macroeconomics Notes

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1 Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

Gross Domestic Product (GDP) is the total market value of all **final goods and services** produced **within a country's borders** in a **specific time period**.

GPD does not include:

- Intermediate goods
- Non-market activities
- Used goods transactions
- Financial transactions
- Illegal activities
- Environmental externalities

2 Methods of Measuring GDP

1. Production (Value-Added) Approach:

- Aggregates the value added at each stage of production.
- Value added = Revenue – Cost of intermediate inputs.

2. Expenditure Approach:

- Adds up total spending on final goods and services.
- $GDP = \text{Consumption} + \text{Investment} + \text{Government Spending} + (\text{Exports} - \text{Imports})$.

3. Income Approach:

- Sums all incomes earned by households and businesses during production.
- $GDP = \text{Labor income} + \text{Capital income}$.
- $GDP = \text{Wages} + \text{Profit} + (\text{Rent} + \text{Interest}) + (\text{Indirect Taxes} - \text{Subsidies}) + \text{Depreciation} + \dots$

3 Gross National Product (GNP)

Gross National Product (GNP) is the total market value of all **final goods and services** produced by a country's residents and businesses, regardless of where that production takes place during a specific time period.

- GDP focuses on *where* production happens.
- GNP focuses on *who* produces it (the country's citizens and businesses).

The relationship between GNP and GDP:

$$\text{GNP} = \text{GDP} + \text{Net Factor Income from Abroad}$$

Where "Net Factor Income from Abroad" represents income earned by domestic residents from foreign investments minus income earned by foreign residents from domestic investments. This means if a country earns more from abroad than foreigners earn domestically, GNP will be higher than GDP, and vice versa.

4 National Income Accounting Identity

The relationship between a country's total income and its expenditures:

$$Y = C + I + G + (X - M)$$

Where Y is GDP, C is household consumption, I is business investment, G is government purchases, and $(X - M)$ is net exports.

1. Consumption (C)

- *Definition:* All household spending on goods and services, excluding new housing.
- *Includes:*
 - **Durable Goods:** Long-lasting items (cars, household appliances, furniture).
 - **Non-Durable Goods:** Quick-use items (food, clothing, gasoline).
 - **Services:** Non-physical, intangible products (healthcare, legal services, education).

2. Investment (I)

- *Definition:* Private sector spending on capital goods and changes in inventories.
- *Includes:*
 - **Business Fixed Investment:** Capital expenditures by firms (equipment, factories).
 - **Residential Fixed Investment:** Spending on new housing units by households and landlords (new home constructions and purchases, major home renovations).
 - **Inventory Investment:** Changes in the stock of unsold goods held by firms.
- *Excludes:* Financial assets like stocks, bonds, or cryptocurrencies, as these do not represent production.

3. Government Spending (G)

- *Definition:* Government purchases of goods and services.
- *Includes:*
 - Federal, state, and local spending on goods and services.

- *Excludes:* Transfer payments (social security, unemployment benefits, welfare), because these are not payments for goods or services.

4. Net Exports (NX = Exports – Imports)

- *Definition:* The difference between exports (X) and imports (M).
- *Includes:*
 - **Exports (X):** Goods and services produced domestically and sold to foreign buyers.
 - **Imports (M):** Goods and services produced abroad and purchased by domestic consumers.
- Can result in trade surplus (positive) or deficit (negative).

5 Typical GDP Component Distribution

Expenditure Approach:

- Consumption (C): $\sim 70\%$ – *Largest component*
- Investment (I): $\sim 15\text{-}20\%$
- Government (G): $\sim 15\text{-}20\%$
- Net Exports (NX): $\sim \pm 5\%$ – *Smallest component*

Income Approach

- Wages: $\sim 50\text{-}60\%$ – *Largest component*
- Profits: $\sim 20\text{-}30\%$
- Rent + Interest: $\sim 5\text{-}10\%$
- Indirect Taxes - Subsidies: $\sim 5\text{-}10\%$
- Depreciation: $\sim 10\text{-}15\%$

6 Disposable Income

Disposable Personal Income (DPI) is the amount of money that households have available to spend or save after paying income taxes: Disposable Income = Gross Income - Taxes.

$$Y^d = Y - T \quad \text{or} \quad Y^d = C + S$$

Where Y^d is disposable income, Y is total income, T is taxes, C is consumption, S is savings.

7 Net Domestic Product (NDP)

Net Domestic Product (NDP) measures the total value of all final goods and services produced within a country in a given period, after subtracting depreciation.

7.1 NDP at Market Prices (NDP-MP)

NDP at Market Prices is valued at the prices paid by buyers, including indirect taxes net of subsidies.

$$\text{NDP-MP} = \text{GDP} - \text{Depreciation}$$

7.2 NDP at Factor Cost (NDP-FC)

NDP at Factor Cost is valued at the cost to factors of production, excluding indirect taxes and including subsidies.

$$\text{NDP-FC} = \text{GDP} - \text{Depreciation} - \text{Indirect Taxes} + \text{Subsidies}$$

8 Net Domestic Income (NDI)

Net Domestic Income (NDI) measures the total income earned by all factors of production within a country in a given period, after subtracting depreciation.

8.1 NDI at Market Prices (NDI-MP)

NDI at Market Prices aligns with market prices, including indirect taxes net of subsidies, and equals NDP-MP.

$$\text{NDI-MP} = \text{GDP} - \text{Depreciation}$$

8.2 NDI at Factor Cost (NDI-FC)

NDI at Factor Cost reflects the income to factors, excluding indirect taxes and including subsidies, and equals NDP-FC.

$$\text{NDI-FC} = \text{GDP} - \text{Depreciation} - \text{Indirect Taxes} + \text{Subsidies}$$

9 Real vs. Nominal Variable

- **Nominal Variable:** Measured in current market prices, not adjusted for inflation.
- **Real Variable:** Adjusted for inflation, reflecting the true purchasing power.

$$\text{Real Variable} = \frac{\text{Nominal Variable}}{\text{Price Level}} \times 100$$

Where Price Level is an index like CPI, PPI or GDP deflator.

Purchasing power is the quantity of goods or services that can be bought with a specific amount of money at a specific time.

$$\text{Purchasing Power (for a specific good)} = \frac{\text{Nominal Income}}{\text{Price of the Good}}$$

10 Price Index

A price index is a statistical measure that tracks the average change in prices of a specific basket of goods and services over time, relative to a base period.

Price Index for a Single Good:

$$\text{Price Index} = \frac{\text{Price in Current Year}}{\text{Price in Base Year}} \times 100$$

More formally,

$$PI_t = \frac{P_t}{P_0} \times 100$$

Where P_t is price of good in current year, P_0 is price of good in base year.

Price Index for a Basket of Goods:

$$\text{Price Index} = \frac{\text{Cost of Basket in Current Year}}{\text{Cost of Basket in Base Year}} \times 100$$

or,

$$\text{Price Index} = \frac{\sum(\text{Price in Current Year} \times \text{Quantity in Base Year})}{\sum(\text{Price in Base Year} \times \text{Quantity in Base Year})} \times 100$$

More formally,

$$PI_t = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (P_{i,t} \times W_i)}{\sum_{i=1}^n (P_{i,0} \times W_i)} \times 100$$

or,

$$PI_t = \sum_{i=1}^n w_i \times \frac{P_{i,t}}{P_{i,0}} \times 100$$

Where:

- n = Total number of goods in the basket.
- $P_{i,t}$ = Price of good i in current year.
- $P_{i,0}$ = Price of good i in base year.
- W_i = Weight (proportion of spending) for good i .
- $w_i = \frac{W_i}{\sum W_i}$.

Laspeyres Price Index:

$$PI_t^L = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (P_{i,t} \times Q_{i,0})}{\sum_{i=1}^n (P_{i,0} \times Q_{i,0})} \times 100$$

Where $Q_{i,0}$ is quantity of good i in base year.

11 Changes in Nominal and Real GDP

1. Nominal GDP = $\sum (P_t \times Q_t)$:

- *Definition:* Value of output in current prices.
- Changes in nominal GDP can be due to:
 - **Changes in Prices** (P_t): Inflation or deflation.
 - **Changes in Quantities** (Q_t): More or less output produced (real growth or decline).

2. Real GDP = $\sum (P_0 \times Q_t)$:

- *Definition:* Value of output in constant base-year prices.
- Changes in real GDP can be due to:
 - **Changes in Quantities Only** (Q_t): Prices are fixed, so only output changes matter.

12 Calculating Nominal and Real GDP

Recall that $GDP = P_1Q_1 + P_2Q_2 + \dots + P_nQ_n$

Nominal GDP: Nominal GDP is the total monetary value of final goods and services produced in year t , using current prices:

$$\text{Nominal GDP}_t = \sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,t} \times Q_{i,t}$$

Real GDP: Real GDP measures the value of production in year t using constant prices from a base year b :

$$\text{Real GDP}_t = \sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,b} \times Q_{i,t}$$

13 Growth Rate

$$\text{Growth Rate} = \frac{X_{\text{end}} - X_{\text{start}}}{X_{\text{start}}} \times 100$$

Where X_{start} is value in the initial year, and X_{end} is value in the final year.

14 GDP Deflator

The GDP deflator is a price index that measures the aggregate price level of all goods and services produced in an economy, relative to a base year. It reflects how much of the change in GDP is due to price changes rather than actual output changes.

$$\text{GDP Deflator}_t = \frac{\text{Nominal GDP}_t}{\text{Real GDP}_t} \times 100$$

- If GDP Deflator > 100 , prices have increased since the base year (inflation).
- If GDP Deflator < 100 , prices have decreased since the base year (deflation).

15 Limitations of GDP

- **Excludes Non-Market Activities:** Household labor, volunteer work, and other unpaid services aren't counted despite their economic value.
- **Ignores Income Distribution:** GDP measures total output but reveals nothing about how income is distributed across the population.
- **Overlooks Environmental Costs:** Environmental degradation and resource depletion aren't subtracted from GDP calculations.
- **Overstates Well-Being in Cases of Negative Events:** Disasters and wars increase GDP due to reconstruction but do not improve living standards.
- **Disregards Quality Improvements:** GDP struggles to capture quality enhancements in goods and services over time.
- **Fails to Measure Quality of Life:** Leisure time, health outcomes, and overall quality of life aren't reflected in GDP figures.

- **Does Not Capture Underground Economy:** Informal and illegal economic activities are excluded from official GDP calculations.
- **Focuses on Production, Not Sustainability:** GDP measures current production without considering whether economic activity is sustainable long-term.
- **Counts Defensive Expenditures Positively:** Spending to fix problems (pollution cleanup, crime prevention) increases GDP despite not improving welfare.

16 Consumer Price Index (CPI)

The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures the average price change over time for a fixed basket of goods and services consumed by households. It is a key indicator of inflation.

$$CPI_t = \frac{\text{Cost of Consumer Basket in Year } t}{\text{Cost of Consumer Basket in Base Year}} \times 100$$

More formally,

$$CPI_t = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,t} \times Q_{i,0}}{\sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,0} \times Q_{i,0}}$$

17 Limitations of CPI

- **Substitution Bias:** Doesn't account for consumers switching to cheaper alternatives when prices rise, potentially overstating inflation.
- **Ignores Quality Improvements:** Struggles to accurately measure improvements in product quality over time.
- **Excludes New Goods:** CPI does not quickly reflect newly introduced products and services.
- **Does Not Capture Changes in Shopping Patterns:** Discounts, bulk buying, and online shopping trends are overlooked.

18 Producer Price Index (PPI)

The Producer Price Index (PPI) measures the average change in selling prices received by domestic producers for their goods and services over time. It tracks price changes from the perspective of the seller rather than the consumer.

$$PPI_t = \frac{\text{Cost of Producer Basket in Year } t}{\text{Cost of Producer Basket in Base Year}} \times 100$$

More formally,

$$PPI_t = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,t} \times Q_{i,0}}{\sum_{i=1}^n P_{i,0} \times Q_{i,0}}$$

19 Inflation Rate

Inflation Rate measures the percentage change in the general price level of goods and services in an economy over a specific period, typically measured annually.

$$\text{Inflation Rate} = \frac{\text{Price Index in Current Period} - \text{Price Index in Base Period}}{\text{Price Index in Base Period}} \times 100$$

More formally,

$$\pi_t = \frac{P_t - P_{t-1}}{P_{t-1}} \times 100$$

Where π_t is inflation rate in period t , P_t is price index in period t , P_{t-1} is price index in period $t - 1$.

20 Hyperinflation

Hyperinflation is **an extremely high and typically accelerating rate of inflation**, usually exceeding **50% per month**. It leads to the rapid devaluation of money, making it nearly worthless as a medium of exchange.

- **Causes:**

- Excessive Money Printing
- Loss of Confidence in Currency
- Collapse of Tax Revenue & Government Spending Imbalances

- **Effects of Hyperinflation:**

- Money Loses Value Rapidly
- Barter & Foreign Currencies Replace Local Currency
- Severe Economic Instability

21 The Costs of Inflation

- **Distorts Price Signals:** Inflation makes it difficult to distinguish between genuine increases in demand and overall price level changes, leading to misallocation of resources.
- **Erodes Purchasing Power:** If wages do not keep up with rising prices, consumers can afford less, reducing real income.
- **Increases Uncertainty in Financial Markets:** High inflation makes long-term contracts, investments, and loans riskier, discouraging economic stability.
- **Hurts Savers, Benefits Borrowers:** The value of money declines over time, reducing the real value of savings while making debt repayment easier.
- **Imposes Menu Costs:** Businesses must frequently update price lists, catalogs, and systems, increasing operational expenses.
- **Leads to Shoe-Leather Costs:** People reduce cash holdings to avoid losing value, making frequent trips to banks and increasing transaction inefficiencies.
- **Disrupts International Competitiveness:** If domestic inflation is higher than that of trade partners, exports become more expensive, reducing global demand.
- **Complicates Taxation and Contracts:** Inflation interacts with fixed nominal tax brackets and wages, leading to unintended financial distortions.

22 The Costs of Deflation

- **Reduces Consumer Spending:** When prices fall, consumers delay purchases expecting even lower prices, leading to lower demand and economic slowdown.
- **Increases Debt Burden:** As the real value of money rises, the burden of existing debt increases, making it harder for borrowers to repay loans.
- **Leads to Wage Cuts and Unemployment:** Employers lower wages to match falling prices, but since wages are often sticky, businesses resort to layoffs instead.
- **Hurts Business Revenues and Profits:** Firms earn lower nominal revenues, forcing them to cut costs through wage reductions, layoffs, or reduced investment.
- **Discourages Investment:** Businesses hesitate to invest when future revenues are uncertain, slowing down capital formation and technological progress.
- **Increases Real Interest Rates:** With nominal rates near zero, deflation raises real interest rates, discouraging borrowing and further reducing economic activity.
- **Creates a Deflationary Spiral:** Lower demand leads to lower prices, which further reduces spending and investment, trapping the economy in prolonged stagnation.
- **Weakens Government Fiscal Policy:** Tax revenues fall due to declining incomes and spending, limiting government ability to stimulate the economy.
- **Transfers Wealth from Borrowers to Lenders:** Since the real value of debt increases, borrowers face higher repayment burdens, while lenders gain greater purchasing power from fixed loan repayments.

23 Approximations for Percentage Changes

- **Product Rule:**

$$\% \Delta (X \times Y) \approx \% \Delta X + \% \Delta Y$$

- The percentage change of a product is approximately the sum of the percentage changes of its components.

- **Ratio Rule:**

$$\% \Delta (X/Y) \approx \% \Delta X - \% \Delta Y$$

- The percentage change of a ratio is approximately the difference in percentage changes of the numerator and denominator.

- **Logarithmic Approximation:**

$$\ln(1 + x) \approx x \quad \text{for small } x.$$

24 Logarithmic Approximations in Growth Rate Calculations

- **GDP Growth Approximation:**

$$g_t \approx \ln(GDP_t) - \ln(GDP_{t-1})$$

- The difference in logs approximates the percentage growth.

- **Real Wage Growth Approximation:**

$$g_{w_r} \approx g_{w_n} - \pi$$

- Real wages grow at the rate of nominal wages minus inflation.

25 Unemployment

- **Employed (E):** A person 16 or older who:
 - Works for **at least 1 hour per week** for pay, or
 - Works **15+ unpaid hours** in a family business, or
 - Has a job but is **temporarily absent** (e.g., sick leave, vacation), paid or unpaid.
- **Unemployed (U):** A person 16 or older who:
 - **Is not working**, but
 - **Is available for work**, and
 - **Has actively searched for a job in the last 4 weeks** (e.g., sending CVs, interviewing).
- **Labor Force (L):** The total number of employed and unemployed in an economy.

$$L = E + U$$

- **Not in Labor Force (POP - L):** A person who is **neither employed nor unemployed** (e.g., retirees, students not seeking jobs, discouraged workers).
- **Unemployment Rate:** The percentage of the labor force that is unemployed.

$$u = \frac{U}{L} \times 100$$

- **Labor Force Participation Rate (LFPR):** The percentage of the total adult population that is in the labor force.

$$LFPR = \frac{L}{POP} \times 100$$

26 Types of Unemployment

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------------|
| • Frictional Unemployment | • Cyclical Unemployment |
| • Structural Unemployment | • Seasonal Unemployment |

27 Frictional Unemployment

Frictional unemployment refers to **short-term unemployment** that arises from the normal functioning of the labor market. It occurs even when there are enough jobs available because it takes time for workers and employers to find a good match.

- **Key Characteristics:** Temporary, inevitable, and exists even in healthy economies with full employment.
- **Causes:**

- **Job Search Process:** Workers take time to find jobs that best match their skills and preferences.
- **Mismatch of Skills & Job Requirements:** Different jobs require different skills, and workers may need time to find suitable positions.
- **Geographic Mobility Delays:** Workers may need time to relocate for jobs.
- **Imperfect Information:** Employers and job seekers may not immediately know about all available opportunities.
- **Sectoral Shifts:**
 - **Technological Changes:** Some jobs disappear while new ones emerge.
 - **Trade Adjustments:** International trade shifts labor demand.
- **Policy Implications:** Can be reduced through improved job matching services, better information dissemination, and retraining programs, but cannot be eliminated entirely.

28 Structural Unemployment

Structural unemployment occurs when **workers' skills or location do not match available jobs**, leading to long-term unemployment. It results from **fundamental changes in the economy**, such as technological advancements, shifts in industries, or labor market policies. Unlike frictional unemployment, it persists even when jobs are available because affected workers lack the necessary qualifications or mobility.

- **Key Characteristics:** Longer-term than frictional unemployment, often requires significant retraining or relocation to resolve.
- **Causes:**
 - **Technological Change:** Automation and artificial intelligence replace jobs.
 - **Globalization & Trade:** Industries decline as production shifts to lower-cost countries.
 - **Geographic Mismatch:** Jobs may be available in certain regions, but workers are unwilling or unable to relocate.
 - **Education & Skill Gaps:** Outdated skills make workers unemployable in modern industries.
 - **Labor Market Policies:** Minimum wages, strong labor unions, and employment protection laws can prevent wages from adjusting, increasing structural unemployment.
- **Wage Rigidity:** Structural unemployment is worsened by **real wage rigidity**, where wages remain **above the market-clearing level**, leading to excess labor supply
 - **Minimum Wage Laws:** If the legal minimum wage is above equilibrium, low-skilled workers may struggle to find jobs.
 - **Labor Unions:** Unions negotiate higher wages, which can lead to job losses in unionized sectors.
 - **Efficiency Wages:** Firms pay above-market wages to boost productivity, reduce turnover, and attract better workers, but this reduces hiring.
- **Policy Implications:** Requires targeted interventions like worker retraining programs, education reform, and regional development initiatives rather than general economic stimulus.

29 Cyclical Unemployment

Cyclical unemployment is **unemployment caused by fluctuations in the business cycle**. It increases during **recessions** when economic activity slows and decreases during **expansions** when demand for labor rises. Unlike frictional and structural unemployment, it is directly related to the overall health of the economy.

- **Key Characteristics:** Temporary but potentially widespread, affecting otherwise qualified workers due to insufficient aggregate demand.
- **Causes:**
 - **Decline in Aggregate Demand:** When consumer and business spending fall, firms cut production and lay off workers.
 - **Economic Recessions:** A contraction in GDP reduces hiring, causing unemployment to rise.
 - **Financial Crises:** Banking failures and credit shortages lead to lower investment and job losses.
 - **Global Economic Shocks:** External crises (e.g., oil price spikes, pandemics) disrupt markets, reducing demand for labor.
- **The Relationship Between Cyclical Unemployment & the Business Cycle:**
 - **Expansion (Boom):** Demand for goods and services increases → Businesses hire more workers → Unemployment falls.
 - **Recession (Bust):** Demand declines → Businesses cut production → Unemployment rises.
- **Policy Response:** Unlike other unemployment types, cyclical unemployment can be directly addressed through:
 - Monetary policy (interest rate adjustments)
 - Fiscal policy (government spending and taxation)
 - Automatic stabilizers (unemployment insurance)

30 Natural Rate of Unemployment

The **natural rate of unemployment** is the unemployment rate that the economy tends toward in the **long run**, when it is functioning normally. It consists of **frictional** and **structural unemployment** but excludes **cyclical unemployment**.

$$\text{Actual Unemployment} = \text{Natural Rate of Unemployment} + \text{Cyclical Unemployment}$$

Where: Natural Rate of Unemployment = Frictional Unemployment + Structural Unemployment.
More formally,

$$u = u^* + u_c$$

Where:

- u = Actual unemployment rate.
- u^* = Natural rate of unemployment (includes frictional and structural unemployment).
- u_c = Cyclical unemployment (caused by business cycle fluctuations).

Breaking it down further:

$$u = u_f + u_s + u_c$$

Where:

- u_f = Frictional unemployment rate (due to job search and matching).
- u_s = Structural unemployment rate (due to wage rigidity and mismatches).
- u_c = Cyclical unemployment rate (due to economic fluctuations).

A related concept is **NAIRU (Non-Accelerating Inflation Rate of Unemployment)**, which is the unemployment rate at which **inflation remains stable**.

- If **actual unemployment** = **NAIRU**, the economy is in **equilibrium**, and inflation is stable.
- If **actual unemployment** > **NAIRU**, the economy is in **recession**, and inflation tends to fall.
- If **actual unemployment** < **NAIRU**, the economy is **overheating**, and inflation tends to rise.

NAIRU and Inflation Relationship:

- If **unemployment falls below NAIRU**, firms compete for scarce workers, raising wages → higher costs → **inflation rises**.
- If **unemployment rises above NAIRU**, wage pressures decline → demand weakens → **inflation falls**.
- This tradeoff is linked to the **Phillips Curve**, which shows the inverse relationship between unemployment and inflation.

31 Fisher Equation

The Fisher equation describes the relationship between **nominal interest rates**, **real interest rates**, and **inflation expectations**. It helps explain how inflation affects borrowing, lending, and investment decisions.

Core Fisher Equation:

$$i = r + \pi$$

Where:

- i = Nominal interest rate (observed market rate)
- r = Real interest rate (adjusted for purchasing power)
- π = Inflation rate

Exact Fisher Equation:

$$1 + i = (1 + r)(1 + \pi)$$

$$i = r + \pi + r\pi$$

32 The Quantity Theory of Money

$$M \times V = P \times Y$$

Where:

- M is the money supply (the total amount of money in circulation)
- V is the velocity of money (how quickly money changes hands)
- P is the price level
- Y is the real output (the quantity of goods and services)